

different aircraft, increasing development costs, but orders soon began to flood in. Here was a four-engined jet with a range and payload that would transform long-distance travel.

The Boeing 707 came into service in October 1958, flying the Pan Am transatlantic routes from Idlewild Airport, New York, to Paris and London. Although configurations varied, the 707 carried more than twice as many passengers as the new model Comets and substantially more than the latest propellers. Flying at 600mph (960kph), it was far quicker than a propeller or even a turboprop. At a stroke, long-distance journey times were almost halved.

The 707 was not without its problems. Like all early jets, it may have been quiet for its passengers but it was howlingly noisy for people living around airports. Also, the first 707s entered

service with inadequate engines. These JT-3 turbojets had to be water-injected to produce enough thrust for takeoff and only allowed a range of around 3,000 miles (4,800km). The 707s were soon, however, being equipped with more powerful and fuel-efficient fan-jet engines, as well as having a larger wing. The turbofan-engined 707-320B, which became the standard model after 1962, had a range of around 4,500 miles (7,200km), still far short of today's

long-haul airliners but perfectly adequate for intercontinental flights.

With the introduction of the Boeing 707, jet air travel took the world by storm. People simply did not want to fly with propellers any longer. Operators of turboprops began advertising them (accurately) as jet-powered, and TWA even dubbed its latest Constellation the "Jetstream" – presumably hoping to associate the propliner with some of the glamour of the jet age.



JET NETWORK

This route map shows Pan Am's worldwide passenger jet network in the 1960s. Note the massive blank on the map represented by the Soviet Union and China, no-go areas for American airlines.

